

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 7
♥ K 8 4
♦ Q 6 4
♣ K 9 6 3

♠ 8 6 2

♥ A Q J 7 5 3

♦ 9 5

♣ A 2



♠ J 10 4 3

♥ 9 2

♦ A J 8 7

♣ Q 8 7

♠ K 9 5

♥ 10 6

♦ K 10 3 2

♣ J 10 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♥		
All Pass			
Lead: ♠J			

North opens 1♥. What should we bid? We respond 1NT, just as in standard bidding. The difference is that in this case the 1NT response is forcing on North. North rebids ♥s, promising at least a 6-card suit.

You have nothing to say over 2♥ except pass. Notice that this is the same bidding and same final contract that would have been reached with standard bidding. Using 2/1 is often like that.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 10 9 5
 ♥ 10 9 6
 ♦ K 10 8 6
 ♣ A

♠ 7 3

♥ K Q J

♦ J 3

♣ K 10 8 6 4 3



♠ K J 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 9 7 5

♣ Q 2

♠ 8 6 4

♥ A 5 3 2

♦ 4 2

♣ J 9 7 5

West

1 ♠

3 ♦

All Pass

Lead: ♥K

North

Pass

Pass

East

2 ♦

4 ♠

South

Pass

How do you open the bidding? You open 1 ♠. East responds 2 ♦, a natural 2/1 force to game. What do you rebid?

You cannot rebid your ♠s, but you have decent support for partner's ♦s, so raise to 3 ♦. You are in a game forcing auction so it won't end there. East always intended to play a ♠ contract. He now bids 4 ♠, using Fast Arrival to indicate he has no slam aspirations. 4 ♠ is cold, and if the defenders don't take their ♥ tricks immediately you will make an overtrick.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ Q

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ J 10 6

♥ 9

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K Q J 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 5

♥ J 10 6 5 3 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ A

♠ K 9 2

♥ A K 8 7 4

♦ K 10 7

♣ 10 8

South opens 1♥ and West Doubles.

After the intervening Takeout Double **2/1 is OFF**. If you had 10 or more points you would Redouble. So even with only 9 points you can bid 2♣ without fear that South will think you have a strong hand. South also knows everything mentioned above so he passes.

West

North

East

South

1♥

Dbl

2♣¹

All Pass

1. 6+ ♣s, fewer than 10 points

Lead: ♦Q

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 2
 ♥ J 2
 ♦ Q J 8 6 2
 ♣ A K J

♠ 5
 ♥ A 10 6 5 3
 ♦ 10 5 4
 ♣ 10 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 8 7 6 4
 ♥ K Q 7
 ♦ K 7 3
 ♣ -

♠ 10 3
 ♥ 9 8 4
 ♦ A 9
 ♣ Q 8 7 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
3 ♠	Pass	4 ♣	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			

Lead: ♦ A

favored that one Ace being a red one and tried the slam. Moral: Don't use Blackwood when you have a void.

You have a great hand - how will you start the bidding? You open 1 ♠. West responds 2 ♦, a 2/1 force to game. You have a big hand, perhaps in the slam range, but first priority is to set a trump suit. So you contend yourself with a rebid of 2 ♠. West agrees on trumps by bidding 3 ♠ (not Fast Arrival). What do you do now? Now you make your slam try by using a Control-showing cue-bid. She bids 4 ♣, showing first or second round control of the suit (Ace or king, or singleton or void). West bids 4 ♠. What do you do now?

West's next bid would be a control-showing bid of her own - IF SHE HAD ONE. Since she cannot win the first or second round of either red suit she just returns to 4 ♠. East realizes that they are off two red Aces and passes. Notice that East did not fall into the Blackwood trap. If you HAD asked for Aces, West would have shown one Ace and East wouldn't know what to do next. She might have figured the odds